

smartphone and under *Advanced options*, configure the proxy. It is very simple, except that a message warns you that the proxy will be used by the browser but may not be used by the apps.

While I was monitoring the Squid logs, everything seemed fine. Using various Google apps went via the proxy. And then I noticed that one of the biggest users of data was missing – Facebook!

For the first time on the tablet, I used the browser to go to the Facebook site, which as expected, advised me to have a better experience by installing the app. To my surprise, I found the experience of Facebook's mobile website to be far easier and snappier for my usage, than the app. Besides, as expected, these calls to the Facebook site were now via the proxy.

The major shock for me was that I had become so attuned to the 'app' environment that it had never even occurred to me to try the browser instead!

Also, the app stores build up proprietary

environments, creating very high barriers for new approaches to the mobile platform. The client-server era made Windows the dominant desktop environment and it continues to dominate even today. Now, environments like Firefox OS have trouble even gaining a foothold in this domain, leave alone getting a chance to change the world!

So, I would encourage you all to think before you install the next app. Is it in your best interests or is it in the interest of the site owner? What benefit does it bring you and at what cost? I am not talking about the cost of the app – but the hidden cost of your data being made available to the site owners!  **END**

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The author has earned the right to do what interests him. You can find him online at <http://sethanil.com> and <http://sethanil.blogspot.com>, or you can reach him via email at anil@sethanil.com.

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